

Dubbo Computer Repair Reuse Ewaste Directory 2026 10 06

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Dubbo computer repair, reuse and e-waste directory

Research date: 6 October 2026

Scope: Dubbo NSW options for broken, unwanted or obsolete laptops/desktops; affordable repair; DIY help; low-income access; reuse; recycling; and small-business ITAD.

Evidence labels

- VERIFIED CURRENT — current primary/authoritative source supports the claim.
- LIKELY CURRENT — current business/directory evidence supports operation but an exact service detail is not confirmed.
- HISTORICAL — useful context, not proof of today's service.
- UNVERIFIED — organisation exists but this specific service/access condition could not be established.
- PROPOSED/FUTURE — discussed/planned, not an operating service.

Executive answer

Dubbo has multiple commercial computer-repair businesses and several free household e-waste routes. The research did not identify a verified, inclusive, free/subsidised community computer-hardware repair service or a public hands-on DIY laptop-repair workshop.

The clearest gaps are therefore narrower than "Dubbo has no options":

1. no verified inclusive Repair Café / DIY computer-repair program;
2. no verified means-tested/subsidised hardware-repair labour program;
3. no obvious universal walk-in pathway that promises to take a usable/repairable household computer, sanitise it, refurbish it and redistribute/remarket it before recycling;
4. no publicly described computer reuse-screening step at Whylandra before e-waste recycling;
5. no clearly advertised local small-batch ITAD package combining collection, serialised sanitisation evidence, remarketing and downstream reporting.

Dubbo does have local repair businesses, local refurbished-device supply, No Interest Loans for eligible computer purchases, free household e-waste recycling, and statewide/national commercial ITAD providers.

There is not enough local evidence to claim that large numbers of repairable computers are currently being prematurely recycled. The evidence supports a plausible reuse-leakage risk, not a quantified outcome.

1. Realistic computer-repair options

Publicly verifiable dollar pricing for ordinary Dubbo laptop/desktop repairs was not found. Residents should ask each provider for the diagnostic fee, quote fee, labour, parts, customer-supplied-parts policy and repair warranty before authorising work.

Provider | Evidence | What is currently advertised
CBM Computers | VERIFIED CURRENT | Home/business repairs, servicing/support, RAM/disk/graphics upgrades, OS/software upgrades. 111 Talbragar St; 02 6884 4600.

Right Click Go | VERIFIED CURRENT | Desktop/laptop support, hardware upgrades, memory, software repair, malware/security, backup/recovery, remote/on-site; advertises "No Fix, No Pay". 0466 051 852. Custom Computer Creations | VERIFIED CURRENT | General PC/laptop repairs, data recovery, upgrades, virus removal, gaming/custom systems, iPhone repair. Shop 10, 36 Darling St; 0427 738 999; by appointment. Computer Research & Technology | VERIFIED CURRENT | Home IT support, Windows upgrades, scam/virus help, backup/recovery, performance work and SSD/memory recommendations. 128 Darling St; 02 6884 5922. Leading Edge Computers Dubbo | VERIFIED CURRENT | Repairs, IT services, training, software, and new/refurbished computers. 33 Macquarie St; 02 6881 6880. Orana Business Solutions | VERIFIED CURRENT | Maintenance/repair to most devices and refurbished pre-loved devices; states it will advise if repair is not cost-effective. 122-124 Fitzroy St; 0477 946 651. Tech Savvy Dubbo | LIKELY CURRENT | Current local listing identifies a computer-repair business at Orana Mall. Exact repair scope/prices should be confirmed directly.

What is not reliably published

- ordinary repair prices;
- complete Apple/Chromebook repair capability by shop;
- customer-supplied-parts policies;
- standard battery/screen/keyboard/charging-port prices;
- concessions for low-income residents.

Do not invent price estimates. Ask for a written quote first.

2. Men's Sheds

Dubbo Community Men's Shed

VERIFIED CURRENT: Australian Men's Shed Association lists 171 Talbragar Street, 02 6881 6987, with Wood and Metal Work and Garage Sale activities.

Historical/community material shows a repair/restoration culture and community projects, but current primary evidence does not establish laptop/desktop repair, electronics diagnosis, data sanitisation, computer donation intake, or public computer-repair fees.

South Dubbo Veterans & Community Men's Shed

VERIFIED CURRENT: AMSA lists 60 Palmer Street, 0411 054 832, with Workshop & Repair Activities, Gardening, Aquaponics.

"Workshop & Repair Activities" does not prove computer/electronics repair. No current source found specifies public laptop repair, computer donation/e-waste intake, or data handling.

Women and non-members

AMSA says female membership is a local shed decision. Therefore neither Dubbo shed should be presented as a guaranteed inclusive repair option for women or non-members until the individual shed confirms access.

Partnership potential

Both sheds remain plausible community partners for a future computer Repair Café if they can confirm:

- inclusive public-event access;
- volunteers with actual computer competence;
- insurance/supervision;
- data/privacy consent;
- battery-danger exclusions;
- no inappropriate mains-electrical work.

Sources:

- <https://mensshed.org/sheds/dubbo-community-mens-shed-inc/>
- <https://mensshed.org/sheds/south-dubbo-veterans-community-mens-shed/>
- <https://mensshed.org/about-mens-sheds/what-is-a-mens-shed/>

3. Repair Café / DIY repair

No operating formal Repair Café in Dubbo was identified in the current searches.

Repair Café International's model is a free community meeting place where owners work with volunteers to repair items and retain repair knowledge, rather than a free commercial drop-off repair service.

A NSW benchmark is Waverley Council's Repair Café, which includes computers/electronics alongside other repair categories.

No current Dubbo maker space, hackspace, tool library, public electronics workshop or inclusive hands-on laptop-repair teaching program was identified.

Sources:

- <https://www.repaircafe.org/en/about/>
- <https://www.repaircafe.org/en/faq/>
- https://www.waverley.nsw.gov.au/secondnature/get_involved/circular_economy_opportunities/repair_cafe

4. Free digital help (not hardware repair)

Macquarie Regional Library — Dubbo Tech Help

VERIFIED CURRENT. Free one-on-one 45-minute Tech Help is offered at Dubbo Library during school terms, normally Tuesday 2/3pm and Thursday 10/11am, booking on 02 6801 4510.

It covers basic digital skills, email/apps, mobile printing, library eResources and basic safety/scam awareness.

It explicitly does not provide:

- PC repairs;
- virus removal;
- device setup;
- banking assistance;
- service-provider advice.

Source: <https://www.mrl.nsw.gov.au/programs-and-events/programs-for-adults/tech-help>

Connecting Community Services

Current material advertises free computer/internet access and basic assistance, but no hardware-repair workshop was verified.

Source: <https://ccsd.org.au/community/computer-internet-access>

5. Low-income and digital-inclusion pathways

HopeStreet Dubbo / No Interest Loans

VERIFIED CURRENT: BaptistCare HopeStreet Dubbo, 111 Darling Street, 02 5804 7350, can connect eligible people with No Interest Loans (NILS) for essential technology such as computers/laptops.

Good Shepherd's current NILS eligibility includes people who:

- have a Health Care Card or Pension Card; or
- earn under the published household thresholds; or
- experienced family/domestic violence in the past ten years;

and who meet address/repayment-capacity requirements.

Technology can be financed within the program limit, with no interest, fees or charges.

This is a replacement/purchase pathway, not a free repair scheme.

Sources:

- <https://baptistcare.org.au/hopestreets/locations/dubbo/>
- <https://goodshep.org.au/services/nils/>

NSW / National Device Bank

The NSW Government launched a 12-month Device Bank pilot in May 2026 to refurbish surplus government laptops and distribute them through community organisations to people facing digital-access barriers, including regional communities.

The National Device Bank works through organisations rather than direct individual applications. Its current access page invites organisational expressions of interest and says devices are not presently available.

Sources:

- <https://www.nsw.gov.au/ministerial-releases/nsw-device-bank-to-help-people-and-communities-get-online>
- <https://nationaldevicebank.org.au/access-devices/>

No universal Dubbo charity program was verified that currently provides free laptop hardware repair or guarantees a donated/refurbished computer to any low-income resident.

6. Working or repairable unwanted computers

A reuse-first household sequence is:

1. keep the device in use if it still meets a real need;
2. securely remove personal data, then give/sell directly where appropriate;
3. use an eligible trade-in if offered;
4. ask a local refurbisher/reseller whether it wants the exact model;
5. recycle only when genuinely end-of-life.

Orana Business Solutions demonstrably refurbishes pre-loved devices, and Leading Edge advertises refurbished computers. That proves Dubbo has refurbished-device supply. It does not establish a universal public donation intake.

No current service was found that publicly promises all of: walk-in household computer donation, secure sanitisation, refurbishment, local redistribution/remarketing, and transparent recycling of failures.

7. Whylandra e-waste

VERIFIED CURRENT: Whylandra Waste and Recycling Centre accepts clean, separated domestic e-waste free. Its embedded-battery trial includes whole phones, tablets and laptops; residents are told not to remove embedded batteries. Those devices are sent for specialised recycling to recover materials such as lithium, cobalt and nickel.

Current site rules also state unauthorised scavenging is strictly prohibited.

That means residents cannot simply salvage usable computers from the e-waste area.

No current public source reviewed says Whylandra performs computer-specific reuse/refurbishment triage before recycling.

The free household pathway should not be assumed to cover business IT disposal at scale.

Source:

<https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/Households-Residents/Rubbish-Recycling-and-Sustainability/whylandra-waste-recycling-centre>

8. Retail recycling

Officeworks Dubbo

VERIFIED CURRENT: 10 Erskine Street. Officeworks' Bring It Back program includes technology/data-storage streams, with store instructions for larger devices such as laptops/printers. It also has a separate trade-in pathway for eligible usable technology.

- <https://www.officeworks.com.au/shop/officeworks/storepage/W218/NSW/LINK>
- <https://www.officeworks.com.au/information/about-us/recycling>

JB Hi-Fi

VERIFIED CURRENT: national free in-store e-waste program includes small consumer electronics such as laptops, tablets and monitors; material goes to e-waste recycling.

<https://www.jbhifi.com.au/pages/e-waste-recycling>

Harvey Norman

National program at participating stores accepts categories including laptops, desktops, monitors and printers. Dubbo store exists at 223 Cobra Street, but confirm current participation before travelling.

- <https://www.harveynorman.com.au/e-waste>
- <https://stores.harveynorman.com.au/harvey-norman-dubbo-nsw>

MobileMuster

VERIFIED CURRENT: mobile-product recycling pathway. It explicitly does not accept computers, laptops, tablets or TVs.

<https://www.mobilemuster.com.au/frequently-asked-questions/>

9. Commercial ITAD for Dubbo organisations

Dubbo does not appear to have a clearly advertised local specialist ITAD operator publishing an enterprise package of chain of custody, serialised sanitisation evidence, remarketing and downstream reporting.

National providers can service NSW/regional clients subject to quote.

Providers worth quoting

- PonyUp for Good: corporate collections, data sanitisation through partners, serialised registers on request, reuse/remarketing and recycling fallback.

<https://www.ponyupforgood.com/partners-data-security>

- Greenbox: collection, tracking, sanitisation, remarketing and recycling; secure NSW/ACT facilities and broader service capability.

<https://www.greenbox.com.au/services/asset-recovery/>

- ITC Asset Management: says it services all NSW including regional locations, with NIST 800-88-aligned/Blancco sanitisation, certificates, chain of custody and refurbishment/resale.

<https://www.itcassetmanagement.com.au/locations/nsw/>

Practical rule:

- ~5 devices: local sale/refurb assessment/trade-in or ask an ITAD provider whether value covers logistics.
- ~20 devices: obtain at least two ITAD quotes.
- ~100 devices: formal serialised chain-of-custody, sanitisation evidence, reuse/remarketing and final disposition reporting should be expected.

NIST SP 800-88 Rev.2 superseded Rev.1 in September 2025. Media-aware sanitisation, validation and evidence matter more than simply naming a wipe utility.

- <https://csrc.nist.gov/pubs/sp/800/88/r2/final>
- <https://www.cyber.gov.au/business-government/asds-cyber-security-frameworks/ism/cyber-security-guidelines/guidelines-for-media>

10. Council circular-economy plans

Council's October 2024 meeting outcomes said staff were preparing a business case for reuse shops at Whylandra and Wellington.

Council's progress report for 1 July–31 December 2025 said a draft Whylandra Master Plan was to be presented to Council in March 2026 before community/stakeholder consultation.

The adopted 2025–2035 Waste Strategy includes longer-term resource-recovery/circular-economy planning, including assessment of a resource-recovery park / community circular-economy concept.

The current Whylandra service page still describes disposal/recycling, not an operating IT reuse shop.

These initiatives should therefore be classified PROPOSED/FUTURE, not advertised as current resident services.

Sources:

- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/News-and-Media/News-and-Resources/Council-News/2024/outcomes-from-the-october-ordinary-council-meeting>
- https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/ArticleDocuments/242/Waste_Strategy_2025_Adopted.pdf.aspx
- <https://www.dubbo.nsw.gov.au/ArticleDocuments/11102/Progress%20Report%20-%201%20July%20to%2031%20December%202025.pdf.aspx>

11. Demographic accessibility

Person | Paid repair | Free DIY repair teaching | Affordable replacement | Household recycling
Adult man | Yes | No verified general program; Men's Shed computer support unverified | Refurb

sellers; NILS if eligible | Yes
 Adult woman | Yes | No verified inclusive hands-on option; local Men's Shed female access not guaranteed | Refurb sellers; NILS if eligible | Yes
 Teenager | Commercial repair | No verified youth repair workshop | School-specific/Device Bank partner routes may apply | Household pathway
 Older person | Yes | Library helps digital skills, not repair | NILS if eligible; Device Bank via partner organisation | Yes
 Pensioner | Yes | No verified repair workshop | NILS pathway | Yes
 Low-income parent | Yes but cost barrier | No verified repair workshop | NILS is strongest verified local affordability pathway | Yes
 Person with disability | Yes | No general accessible repair workshop found | NILS/Device Bank partner pathways if eligible | Yes
 First Nations resident | Yes | No specific repair program found | General NILS; Device Bank priority cohorts through organisations | Yes
 CALD/migrant resident | Yes | No specific hardware workshop found | General NILS/Device Bank partner routes | Yes
 Student | Yes | No general workshop found | School-specific/Device Bank organisation route | Yes
 Small business | Yes | Not a free community target | Commercial/refurbished supply | Use commercial/business pathway
 No special eligibility | Yes | No verified option | Refurbished market-price devices | Yes

The clearest underserved group is anyone who wants to learn or participate in an affordable repair instead of handing the device to a commercial shop. That particularly affects women/non-men, low-income residents, young people and households seeking a trusted reuse route.

12. Real-world scenarios

A — low-income parent, laptop stopped charging

Call a commercial repairer and ask the diagnostic/quote fee before travelling. No verified subsidised hardware repair was found. If repair is uneconomic and replacement is essential, HopeStreet can assess NILS eligibility.

B — pensioner wants an SSD upgrade and explanation

CBM, Right Click Go, Custom Computer Creations and CR&T have current evidence supporting upgrade/SSD-memory related help. Library Tech Help can build confidence but cannot perform the repair.

C — woman wants to learn to repair her own laptop

No verified Dubbo service currently meets that exact need. This is the strongest case for an inclusive Repair Café-style pilot.

D — teenager with suspected gaming-PC PSU failure

Use commercial diagnosis before buying parts. No verified youth subsidised repair/DIY hardware workshop was found.

E — family has two working laptops and one broken

Securely erase the working units and prioritise direct reuse/trade-in/refurbisher assessment. Have the broken unit assessed if economically sensible. Recycle only the genuinely end-of-life device.

F — business replaces 25 Windows laptops

Get at least two formal ITAD quotes. Require chain of custody, media-appropriate sanitisation, serialised evidence, failed-wipe handling, reuse/remarketing terms, downstream details and final reporting.

13. Five biggest gaps

1. Inclusive Repair Café / DIY computer repair — HIGH confidence
2. Subsidised community hardware repair — HIGH confidence
3. Clear consumer donation-to-refurbishment pathway — MEDIUM-HIGH
4. Publicly visible reuse-before-recycling triage at Whylandra — MEDIUM-HIGH
5. Local small-batch ITAD bridge — MEDIUM

Do not turn these into a claim that Dubbo has no repair/recycling options.

14. Premature recycling: what the evidence actually supports

No local device-condition waste audit was found.

What is established:

- Whylandra provides free household e-waste recycling and sends embedded-battery devices to specialised recycling;
- public salvage is prohibited;
- no public computer reuse triage is described;
- retailer channels emphasise recycling, although some separate trade-in/reuse pathways exist;
- Council policy broadly prefers avoidance/reuse before recycling.

So there is a plausible leakage risk if a resident chooses the easiest disposal route for a usable machine. There is no evidence-based percentage or count.

A pilot should measure it.

15. Three realistic improvement models

Model 1 — inclusive monthly Tech Repair & Reuse Café

Best first test:

- 6-8 booked devices;
- 30-45 minute owner-assisted sessions;
- laptops/desktops;
- owner supplies parts;
- no repair guarantee;
- no exposed mains-PSU work;
- no swollen/damaged battery work;
- explicit data/backup consent;
- commercial referral for jobs beyond scope;
- existing recycler for genuine end-of-life devices.

Model 2 — triage/referral desk with no device custody

15-minute assessment; identify likely issue; direct to simple DIY, commercial repair, or recycling; help with safe data backup/wipe; keep nothing overnight.

This is lower risk and tests demand.

Model 3 — reuse intake/community refurbishment hub

Later stage only: accept donated household/business PCs, sanitise, repair/upgrade, redistribute/resell, harvest parts and recycle failures.

This has materially greater data-custody, battery, insurance, consumer-law, premises, second-hand dealing and downstream obligations.

16. Recommended first pilot

Run one pre-booked inclusive diagnosis and owner-assisted repair session before creating a permanent organisation.

Boundary:

- 6–8 bookings;
- 30 minutes;
- laptops/desktops only;
- no unattended drop-off or overnight storage;
- no damaged/swollen batteries;
- no board-level/mains electrical work;
- owner stays with device;
- written consent for reboot/reset/software changes;
- owner supplies replacement parts;
- commercial referral list;
- verified e-waste destination.

Measure:

- fault type;
- fixed / part-needed / commercial referral / recycle;
- time used;
- estimated avoided replacement;
- whether owner otherwise would have replaced/recycled;
- demand for follow-up.

17. Practical directory

I need to... | Best current option | Cost | What to know
Get a laptop repaired cheaply | Compare quotes from local repairers | Quote required | No reliable public dollar table found.
Get professional repair | CBM / Right Click Go / Custom / CR&T / Leading Edge / other local repairers | Commercial | Scope varies by fault/model.
Learn to fix my own laptop | No verified inclusive service | – | Library excludes repairs; Men's Shed computer access unverified.
Get free computer help | Dubbo Library Tech Help; Connecting Community Services | Free | Digital skills/access, not hardware repair.
Get a replacement on a tight budget | Local refurbished seller; HopeStreet NILS if eligible | Market price / no-interest loan | NILS finances eligible purchases, not repairs.
Donate working laptop for local refurb | No universal verified walk-in pathway | Usually free if accepted | Ask before drop-off; direct reuse/trade-in may preserve value.
Donate broken-but-repairable laptop | No verified general local program | – | Assess repairability first.
Recycle dead laptop | Whylandra / Officeworks / JB Hi-Fi | Free household/consumer streams | Wipe data first where possible.
Dispose of PC/monitor | Whylandra / Officeworks / JB Hi-Fi / participating NTCRS retailer | Free household/consumer streams | Don't assume household terms apply to business volumes.
Dispose of phones | Whylandra / MobileMuster / eligible retail programs | Free | MobileMuster is mobile stream, not laptops.
Dispose of tablets | Whylandra / accepted retailer stream | Free | MobileMuster excludes tablets.
Dispose of business computers securely | Qualified ITAD quote (e.g. PonyUp, Greenbox, ITC) | Quote | Require chain of custody, sanitisation evidence and final disposition.

18. Recommended next action

The highest-value next evidence is now local operational confirmation, not another broad web search.

Call:

- both Dubbo Men's Sheds;
- Dubbo Library / Connecting Community Services;
- two commercial repairers;
- Council Resource Recovery & Efficiency.

Ask:

1. Do you receive laptops owners abandon because repair is too expensive?
2. Do you repair/refurbish or redistribute any devices?
3. Would you accept referrals from a community Repair Café?
4. Can owners supply common parts?
5. What is the diagnostic/quote fee?
6. What repairs do you refuse?
7. What is your e-waste downstream route?
8. Would you participate in one monthly pilot?
9. What liability/data issue worries you most?
10. What would make a repair event complementary rather than competitive?

Research limitations

This is a web-based current-service investigation, not telephone mystery-shopping. Where a fee, acceptance rule or demographic access condition is unpublished, it is marked unverified rather than guessed.

Opening hours and service rules can change. Negative findings such as "no Repair Café found" mean no current publicly discoverable service was identified through the sources reviewed, not that no informal volunteer repair activity exists.

No local device-condition waste audit was found, so this report does not quantify how many reusable computers enter recycling.

Eligibility for financial assistance, disability support, school programs and charity services is case-specific.

This research is informational and is not legal, electrical, insurance or data-security advice.